

A lump of neutron star material roughly the size of a **tennis ball** would weigh as much as **40 times** all the people on Earth

RED HYPERGIANT
VY Canis Majoris

This red hypergiant has a radius of around 1,420 times that of the Sun, but it has a much shorter life span.

RED SUPERGIANT
Betelgeuse

Once high-mass stars have used the hydrogen in their cores, they expand into much larger supergiants.

BLUE HYPERGIANT
Pistol star

One of the brightest stars ever discovered, the Pistol Star releases as much energy in six seconds as the Sun does in a year.

BLUE SUPERGIANT
Rigel A

Having exhausted all the hydrogen in its core, Rigel A—the main component of the Rigel star system—has swollen to 750 times the diameter of the Sun.

△ Large stars

Giant, supergiant, and hypergiant stars are all much larger than and brighter than main-sequence stars with the same surface temperature. Blue stars tend to be smaller than their red equivalents but are equally bright due to much higher surface temperatures than the red stars.

